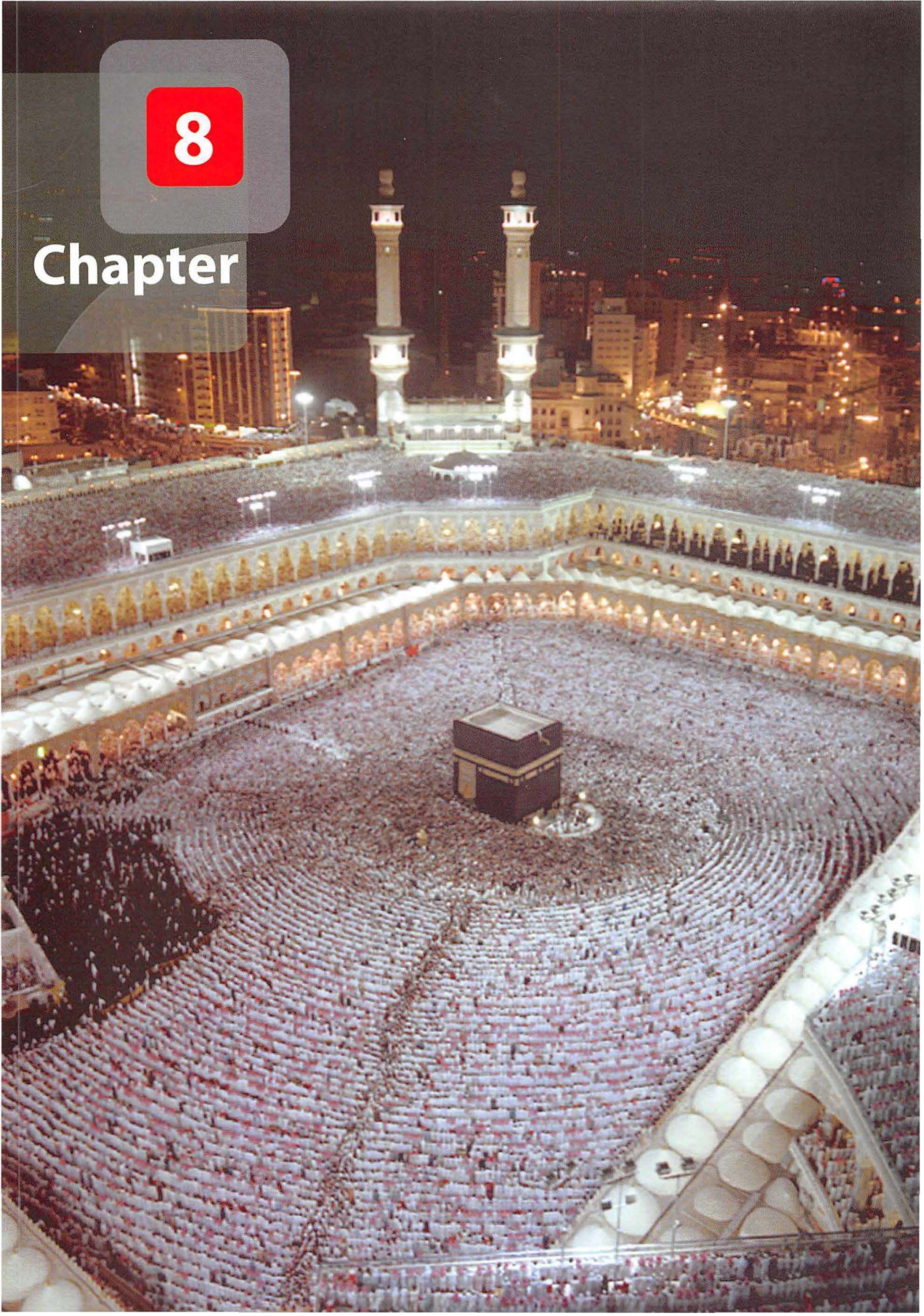
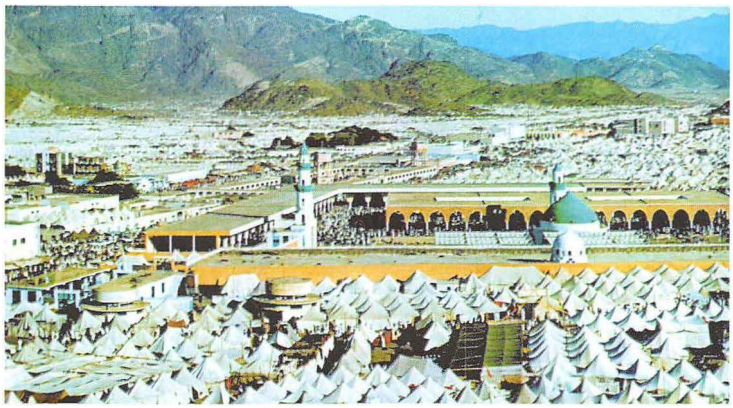

8
Chapter

Hajj – The Pilgrimage اَلْحَجّ



Hajj is the pilgrimage to the House of Allah – the Ka'bah – in Makkah. It is the fifth pillar of Islam. Hajj requires pilgrims to perform certain acts. These acts are the acts of hajj.

Hajj is compulsory for every adult, sane Muslim, male or female, once in his or her lifetime, provided:

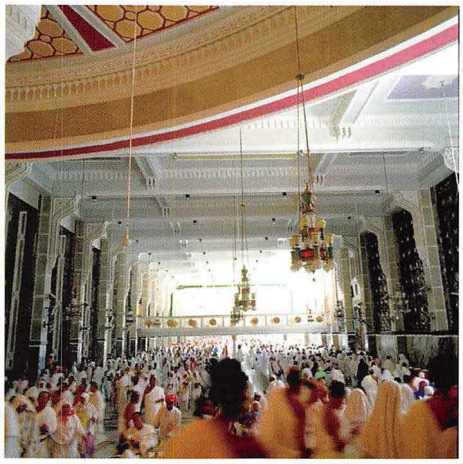
1. He has enough money for the journey,
2. He is in good health,
3. The journey to Makkah is safe and does not involve any danger.

Children may go for hajj with their parents, but it is compulsory for them to perform hajj again when they become adults and are able to do so.

The acts of hajj are as follows:

1. Ihram: the formal intention of performing hajj. A man puts on two pieces of unsewn white cloth and does not cover his head, among other things. A woman should cover everything except for the face and hands.
2. Talbiyah (declaring of one's arrival for hajj).
3. Tawaf – going around the Ka'bah – seven times on arrival at Makkah.
4. Sa'ee – walking seven times back and forth between the two hillocks of Safa and Marwah.
5. Spending the night of 8th Dhul-Hijjah at Mina.
6. Staying in Arafah on 9th Dhul-Hijjah.
7. Spending the night of 9th Dhul-Hijjah at Muzdalifah.
8. Stoning the Jamratul Aqaba in Mina on the 10th of Dhul-Hijjah.
9. Sacrificing an animal in Mina (depending on the type of hajj one is performing).
10. Shaving the head or having a haircut.
11. Tawaf al–Ifadah: going round the Ka'bah seven times, and performing Sa'ee between Safa and

Marwah, according to the type of hajj one is performing. You will learn about the types of hajj in detail later on, inshaa Allah.



12. Stoning the pillars in Mina, on the 11th, 12th and 13th Dhul-Hijjah. Stoning these pillars on the 13th Dhul-Hijjah is optional.
13. The Farewell Tawaf.

Allah's Messenger (ﷺ) said, 'He who makes a pilgrimage to the House – avoiding indecent and immoral behaviour – will return as pure from sins as the day he was born.' (Al-Bukharee)

He also said that a pilgrimage that is mabroor is better than this world and all it contains. There is no reward for such a pilgrimage but Paradise. (Al-Bukharee)

Mabroor means one that is done with the intention of seeking Allah's pleasure only and done in accordance with the Prophet's Sunnah.

Although visiting the Prophet's Mosque in Madinah is not an act of hajj, it is recommended to do so.

Exercises



Exercise 1

Answer the following questions.

1. What is the reward for a pilgrimage that is mabroor?

_____

2. What are the three conditions needed for hajj?

_____

_____

3. What is the meaning of ihram?

_____

_____

Exercise 2

Fill in the blanks.

1. Hajj is the pilgrimage to the _____ in Makkah.
2. Hajj is the _____ pillar of Islam.
3. Tawaf is to go around the Ka'bah _____ times.

Exercises



Exercise 3

Are these statements true or false?

1. If someone is not in good health, he still has to perform hajj. _____
2. Women must cover the face while in a state of ihram. _____
3. Shaving the head is an act of hajj. _____

